Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	2 October 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming gives a team a relaxed, open space where everybody can contribute to creative problem solving. The focus is on quantity over quality: unconventional ideas are welcome, every idea can be built upon, and all participants are encouraged to work together to produce a wide range of solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can let ideas flow and begin shaping concepts, even when you are not in the same room.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Before you collaborate (10 minutes)

A. Team gathering: Four participants took part: the project lead, a ServiceNow developer, a business analyst, and an IT procurement coordinator. Background material (existing laptop request workflow, approval turnaround data, and the standard laptop catalog) was circulated before the session.

B. Set the goal: Generate ideas that use Flow Designer to automate the ordering of standard laptops end to end, from the employee's request to final delivery, with as little manual effort as possible.

C. Learn the facilitation tools: The group went through the facilitation tips to keep the session focused and productive.

Define your problem statement (5 minutes)

PROBLEM

How might we use Flow Designer in ServiceNow to automate standard laptop orders, so that employees get approved devices sooner and the IT team spends less time on repetitive procurement tasks?

Key rules of brainstorming

• Stay on topic • Welcome bold ideas • Hold back criticism • Listen to others • Aim for volume • Be visual where possible

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Brainstorm (10 minutes)

Write down every idea that comes to mind that helps address the problem statement.

Team Member 1	Team Member 2	Team Member 3	Team Member 4
Standard laptop catalog item with ready-made specifications	Flow that bypasses approval for pre-approved job roles	Automatically check availability in asset inventory	Send updates to requester at every stage (approved, shipped, delivered)
Pull role, location and department automatically from the user profile	One-tap manager approval through email or mobile	Raise a purchase order automatically when stock runs low	Live request status tracker on the portal
Allow requests only from eligible employees	Escalate automatically when approval is pending beyond 2 days	Select vendor based on region or contract rate	Create asset record and assign it once delivered
Stop repeat requests during the same refresh cycle	Validate cost center budget before approval	Hold a laptop in advance for new joiners before day one	Dashboard showing turnaround time and cost savings

Group ideas (20 minutes)

Take turns sharing ideas and cluster related notes together as you go. Give each cluster a theme written as a short sentence.

Help employees pick the right laptop easily
- Standard catalog item with default specs
- Details filled in from the user profile
- Eligibility validation and duplicate prevention

Get approvals done without chasing
- No approval needed for pre-approved roles
- One-click manager approval
- Automatic escalation of pending approvals
- Cost center budget validation

Fulfil from stock or vendor automatically
- Stock check and reservation
- Purchase order raised when stock is low
- Vendor chosen by region or price

Keep everyone in the loop
- Notifications at each stage
- Status tracker on the portal

Close the loop and track results
- Asset record created on delivery
- Turnaround and savings dashboard

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Prioritize (20 minutes)

Everyone on the team should agree on what matters most going forward. Place your ideas on the grid to decide which are important and which are feasible.

Importance (vertical) versus **Feasibility - cost, time, effort, complexity (horizontal)**. Ideas in the top-right area are the ones to **Do first**.

1. Standard laptop catalog item	**6.** Auto-created purchase order
2. Skip approval for pre-approved roles	**7.** Auto-escalation of approvals
3. Stock check and reservation	**8.** Auto-created asset record
4. Stage-by-stage notifications	**9.** Vendor assignment by region or price
5. Cost center budget check	**10.** Turnaround and savings dashboard

Importance: if every task could be done with no difficulty or cost, which would have the biggest positive impact?

Feasibility: regardless of importance, which tasks are easier to deliver than others?

Priority	Ideas	Decision
High importance, high feasibility	1, 2, 3, 4	Build first in Flow Designer
High importance, medium feasibility	5, 6, 7	Build next
Lower importance or lower feasibility	8, 9, 10	Plan for a later phase